Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Volume 52, Number 11 | Sunnyvale, California | November 2009

*******Special Election, Voting for President*******

November 11, 7:00 pm, Lakewood Park Building

President's Column

-Michael Majchrowicz

The time has come for me to step down as the president of our neighborhood association. I will be succeeded by the very capable Fred Fowler, pending the formal vote at our November meeting. Fred has served this neighborhood and city many times before, and I am thankful that he is willing to do it again. Please take the time to read Fred's excellent article beginning on this page.

I have greatly appreciated the time I have spent serving on the board, and most of all, have enjoyed forming friendships with people in this neighborhood whom I would not otherwise have met.

I am very glad to see that LVNA will continue, and I hope that more people will become involved. I hope to continue to see many of you often.

Warmest regards,
Michael Majchrowicz

(Almost) President's Corner by Fred Fowler

Greetings neighbors! It has been a long time since I took up the keyboard to write a President's Column for the LVNA Villager, more than 11 years ago. At that time I was just finishing up my 2nd term as LVNA president and just starting my first term as a Sunnyvale City Council member. Lately, I've been enjoying private life and I've been able to attend to lots of odds and ends that my public service forced me to put on hold. Nevertheless, the other day I put in a call to Michael Majchrowicz and volunteered to serve as LVNA president once again. He put the question to the LVNA Board via a telephone poll, and they were very positive about the idea. During the next monthly LVNA meeting, we'll hold a special election to see if all of you would like me to serve again. If you elect me, I will resume my post and do my best to help protect, preserve and improve the quality of life we enjoy in our neighborhood.

WHY DO WE NEED THE LVNA?

Some of us may be wondering why the LVNA exists? It has been around for quite a long time, and some may ask whether it has outlived its usefulness. It publishes a monthly newsletter, stages a picnic, organizes a holiday parade, sponsors a lighting contest, and coordinates volunteers for the City's "Dumpster Day" event. If it stopped doing those things, would anyone care?

"To the praise of the glory of His grace . . ."

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709 Lakewood Drive, Sunnyvale, CA 94089
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Village Crime Statistics:

September 1 - 30, 2009

Assault w/ Deadly Weapon	1
Theft:	1
Burglary:	1
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Sexual Assault	2

(Available at www.crimereports.com)

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HOLIDAY BOUTIQUE at LAKEWOOD SCHOOL!

When? Friday, December 4 - 6:00pm - 9:00pm

Where? Lakewood School, 750 Lakechime Drive in the Cafeteria

All proceeds will benefit the 5th Grade Science Camp scholarship fund!

LAS POSADAS- Columbia Neighborhood Center

A Las Posadas event will take place at the Columbia Neighborhood Center on Friday, December 11th. Families are invited to participate in this Latin American Christmas celebration. There will be piñatas for the children, as well as refreshments. Participants should bring a flashlight and warm jacket for a walk in the neighborhood.

The program is sponsored by the Fremont High School Los Padres group and the Columbia Neighborhood Center.

Location: Columbia Neighborhood Center Gym, 785 Morse Ave., Sunnyvale

Date: Friday, December 11, 2009

Times: Dinner at 6:30 p.m. and Procession at 7:30 p.m.

For more information, call the Columbia Neighborhood Center at **(408) 523-8150.**

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For back issues and other online information about Lakewood Village, visit http://www.lvna.net

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(Fred Fowler continued from pg. 1)

Publishing the newsletter takes the coordinated efforts of at least12 people. Some people write articles, and the editor puts them together into a readable document. Another volunteer sells advertising space, and still another takes the proofs to a local print shop for production. After more than 1,600 copies are printed, another set of volunteers hand delivers copies to each house in our neighborhood. That's quite a bit of time and effort just to give you the publication you are reading now.

The picnic is another large group effort. Someone has to reserve the picnic area, go to local merchants and restaurants to solicit donated food, organize games and activities. Finally, a group of volunteers set up the area, cook the food, serve it, and clean up afterward. It is quite a bit of work for a single day of food and fun.

Both the Parade and Dumpster Day. Also take the dedicated efforts of selfless people to plan, organize and execute. The question some may be asking is, "Why bother"? Do we really need the LVNA anymore?

THE NEIGHBORHOOD NEEDS A VOICE

Over the years, the LVNA has had its ups and downs, and I think we are in one of the "down" periods at the moment. There is currently no president of the organization. The last official president of the LVNA was Michael Majchrowicz, and he hasn't held that office since March. Michael has a job and a life he needs to attend to, and he deserves to have someone else take over for him. Michael has continued to serve as "caretaker" since he stepped down, and we all should be grateful to him for doing so..

I decided to come out of "retirement" for a simple reason. The neighborhood needs the LVNA more than ever. There are lots and lots of challenges facing our neighborhood now. Here are just a few of them:

1. The 49er stadium.

The City of Santa Clara is in the middle of a review process that will most likely result in the building of a football stadium less than a mile east of Lakewood Village. In addition to hosting all of the 49er home games on Sundays and Mondays, the stadium will most likely be used for other events including rock concerts, "monster truck" meets, and a variety of large scale entertainment spectacles. The potential traffic, noise, and crowding impacts on our quiet neighborhood are daunting. Lakewood Village has to find a way to be part of the "conversation" about how the stadium will be built and operated. The LVNA is the only tool we have to do this.

2. North of 237 Development.

There is currently controversy in the City about a proposed overpass linking the north end of Mary Ave with the area north of Highways 237 and 101. The people at the south end of Mary are concerned that this will greatly increase traffic, and that their peace and quiet, their children's safety, and the values of their homes will suffer. Lawrence Expressway is one of the other routes into the same industrial area that the Mary Avenue overpass will serve. We need to be just as watchful and concerned .

Here is a fact that I'll bet very few people in Lakewood Village are aware of. In the early part of my 2nd term on the Sunnyvale City Council, I helped beat back an attempt to completely change Lawrence Expressway in front of our neighborhood. The city manager at the time was proposing to elevate Lawrence Expressway on a huge mound of earth, and create an "urban intersection" at Lakehaven/Sandia similar to the one that now exists at Maude and 237. It would have put the traffic from Lawrence up above the sound walls and spilled noise into the neighborhood.

(Continued on page 3)



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(continued from page 3)
It would have closed access to Lawrence from Lakebird, Lakewood, Palamos and Bridgwood, leaving the Lakehaven/Sandia intersection as the only way in or out of Lakewood village. Luckily, I and others were able to nip this bad idea in the bud. There is no telling when another bad idea like it will raise its head.

3. Neighborhood preservation and Neighborhood Resource Officers.

We're living in the times of tight city budgets. I've been on the Council and have had to make hard choices, but it is important that we as a neighborhood are "at the table" in order to advocate for those services that are key to the future of our neighborhood.

Two city programs affect us more directly than just about any other. One is the Neighborhood Preservation program, and the other is the Neighborhood Resource Officer program. The Neighborhood Preservation program's purpose is to work with people so that the condition of their property doesn't harm the value of their neighbor's property.

The NRO program puts selected Public Safety officers into schools and parks in order to work with kids and keep them out of trouble. Both programs have helped our neighborhood become the nice place it is today. The last time I was LVNA president, there were 6 NROs in the city, plus a supervisor. We are down to one NRO and one NRO/Supervisor. Lakewood Village needs more support from those programs, rather than less. We need to be able to "go to bat" for them when the next city budget is worked out.

WILL YOU JOIN ME?

For all of these reasons and more, I decided to pick up the phone and volunteer to head up the LVNA again. In the end, I decided that the quality of life in our little corner of Sunnyvale matters. It matters enough to me to sacrifice a bit of my private life again in order to work on some of these issues.

How about you? Will you join me? There is plenty of work to do. The LVNA sponsors the parade, the picnic, Dumpster Days, and the other events so that we can get practice working together. That practice pays off when we have to work together to fight back a threat. The 49er stadium, the City Budget, and the other things I've mentioned are all threats. We need to work together to address them.

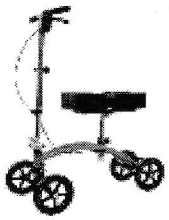
Will you help? Please contact me if you want to pitch in. My e-mail address is fred@fmfa.com. Let me know what you are willing to do. Thank you very much!

Fred Fowler

New Magnet Program at Fairwood Elementary

Fairwood Elementary School will introduce a new, optional Progressive Education magnet program for the 2010 -2011 school year. The "Fairwood Explorer" program will offer a hands-on, challenge-based learning approach utilizing parent participation in the classroom. Parent information sessions will take place in the Fairwood Multi -Use room on Tuesday Dec. 8th at 7 pm. Details of the program can be found on the school's website.

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Upcoming Events for the *Fremont Marching Band*

11/14 - Logan (High School) Show/Competition
11/21 - WBA Championships - Fresno competition
11/29 - Los Altos "Festival of Lights" Parade - Evening parade
12/5 - Lakewood Parade - Joined by Columbia Middle School

The Fremont Marching Band is looking for sponsorships . . . would you like to help?

$1000 - Maestro Level
$500 - Director Level
$400 - Drum Major Level
$250 - Section Leader Level
$50 - Member Level
For more information contact Patty Del Rosario – VP Music Boosters patty_del_r@yahoo.com

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Delivery (Lakewood)	Wendy Stanley	walkers@lvna.net	745-1331
http://www.lvna.net/Miscellany/Contact/contact.html			

Internet Links

LVNA Web Site	http://www.lvna.net
Lakewood Village E-mail List	http://www.topica.com/lists/lakewoodvillage
City of Sunnyvale	http://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov
Sunnyvale Library	http://www.sunnyvalelibrary.org
Sunnyvale Free Recycling	http://groups.yahoo.com/group/sunnyvalefree

Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Street Sweeping	Your street - move your cars!	11/3 Fairwood 11/10 Lakewood 12/1 Fairwood 12/8 Lakewood
Compost Workshop	Sunnyvale Community Center Arboretum	11/21 10 am. - noon
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	Carl Road, near the SMaRT Station	11/21 8 am - 1 pm
LVNA *Villager* Editorial Deadline	Contact editor@lvna.net	11/27
LVNA Meeting	Lakewood Park Bldg	11/11

Important Phone Numbers

Public Safety - Emergency	**911**
Public Safety - Non-emergency	**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance	730-7506
Speeding Cars, parking complaints, traffic signal repair, dead animals	Dispatch 730-7180
Noise complaints, homeless complaints, commercial vehicles on residential streets	Desk Officer 730-7110
Illegal storage or buildings, decrepit fences or buildings, weed problems, illegal home businesses, rental housing complaints, commercial vehicles on private property	Neighborhood Preservation 730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
City Streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights, street sweeping	Public Works 730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline	730-7680
Shopping Cart Pickup	725-1010
Neighborhood Liaison	730-7472
http://www.lvna.net/Resources/Phones/phones.html	

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